Jon Hanks

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SUMMARY

Staff-level Software Engineer with over 15 years experience building reliable backend systems and infrastructure at scale, including ten years at Indeed as a SWE and SRE supporting platform reliability for a job seeker profile system used by 350M+ monthly users. Most recently contributed to infrastructure engineering, cloud cost optimization, and AI agent tooling at Sublime Security. Hands-on experience with multi-cloud infrastructure (AWS, Azure), generative AI tooling, and MCP server development. Seeking a backend/infrastructure IC role to apply reliability engineering and applied AI expertise.

KEY SKILLS

- **Languages:** Python (Django, Flask), TypeScript, JavaScript, Java, C++, C#
- **Cloud & Infrastructure:** AWS, Azure, Kubernetes, Docker, Terraform, PostgreSQL, Datadog, Jenkins, CI/CD, Infrastructure as Code, Observability
- **AI & Agent Tooling:** Generative AI tooling, Model Context Protocol (MCP) server development, AI agent integration, AI-assisted development (Cursor, Claude, GitHub Copilot)
- **Architecture:** Microservices, Software Architecture & Design, GitHub, GitLab
- **Leadership:** Strategic Planning, Budgeting & Cost Optimization, Mentorship & Coaching, Cross-Functional Collaboration, Interviewing

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Sublime Security - Software Engineer, Infrastructure Engineering *Feb 2026 – Jul 2026*

(Role scoped and compensated at Staff level; company did not use formal engineering levels)

- Contributed to the AWS deployment architecture for a new click-tracking service on the infrastructure platform.
- Participated in a t-shirt-sizing analysis of infrastructure capacity and helped right-size PostgreSQL database instances, contributing to scaling benchmarks for onboarding new customers cost-effectively.
- Cut Datadog synthetic test costs by 80% as part of a broader infrastructure cost-optimization initiative.
- Extended the company's internal AI agent (Gimlet) and Notion MCP server integration
- Created an Gen AI-driven triage system that automatically reviews incoming AWS provider notices and flags critical items for the infrastructure team.
- Supported migration of the team's Kubernetes architecture stack to Azure cloud.
- Served in the on-call rotation, supporting incident response and diagnosis for infrastructure and reliability events.

Mercor - Contract AI Trainer, Software Engineering *Aug 2025 – Jan 2026*

- Evaluated and trained AI models on software engineering tasks and code quality as a contract subject-matter expert.

Indeed - Staff Software Engineer – Reliability (SRE) *Apr 2022 – Jul 2025*

- Pioneered a generative AI-based tool to automatically identify and migrate custom Datadog metrics to built-in APM metrics, validating potential for millions of dollars in annual cost savings.
- Led the design and implementation of schema validation for the job seeker profile backend, eliminating a major data integrity issue and preventing production incidents on a platform used by 350M+ monthly users.
- Developed a Model Context Protocol (MCP) server in Python enabling AI agents to query historical incident data from PagerDuty logs, streamlining AI agent development for context-aware analysis.
- Conducted interviews and led system design/coding assessments for 100+ software engineer and management candidates; mentored mid-level and senior engineers on career growth and impact.
- Served as SRE for Indeed's Video Interview Platform, partnering with product teams to define and monitor SLOs/SLIs.
- Led a zero-downtime upgrade of a mission-critical Aurora MySQL cluster for the job seeker profile backend, serving 350M+ monthly users.

Indeed - Staff Software Engineer *Dec 2018 – Apr 2022*

- Led a team of four engineers building tools for security, accessibility, and test automation across the SDLC, including SCRAPL - an automated accessibility testing platform using headless Windows containers to validate screen reader experiences at scale.

- Architected systems on AWS, Docker, and Terraform to improve engineering efficiency and reliability; consulted with teams on DevOps, CI/CD, microservices, and infrastructure-as-code best practices.

Indeed - Software Engineer *Nov 2014 – Dec 2018*

- Built a Docker-based local development environment system enabling one-command setup, boosting engineering productivity through 10x company growth.
- Led the global migration of 100+ applications from Python 2 to Python 3, establishing Python as Indeed's most popular language for new development; authored the official Python style guide and standardized service frameworks and libraries.
- Built a Python/Flask/RabbitMQ service to monitor git commits, detect merge conflicts, and automate branch merging, enabling continuous delivery.

EARLY CAREER

- **Prepify - CTO & Cofounder, Austin, TX:** Led the technical team at this seed-stage startup to build and launch a web-based SAT learning platform (Python, Django, JavaScript), meeting spec and timeline goals.
- **Adlucent - Product Manager Intern, Austin, TX:** Developed an internal Google AdWords optimization system that increased ROI by 22%.
- **Mesozoic Media - Founder, Austin, TX:** Founded an internet marketing startup with a platform managing 3M+ products across multiple sites.
- **Additional software engineering roles:** Pixel Mine Games, Super Happy Fun Fun, Multimedia Games (Everi Holdings), Austin, TX.

EDUCATION

University of Texas, Austin, TX - Master of Business Administration

Virginia Tech, Blacksburg, VA - B.S., Computer Science, Mathematics

GPA: 3.93 | With Honors (Phi Beta Kappa)